

DIRECT CURRENT (DC)

An electric current that flows in a constant direction. *See also* Alternating current (AC).

ELEVATED RAILWAY

Railway built on raised platforms.

EMBANKMENT

Raised pathway across a depression in the landscape that enables a rail track to maintain a shallow gradient.

ENGINE

Power source of a locomotive. It can be driven by steam, electricity, or diesel.

EXPRESS TRAIN

A train that stops only at certain stations on its route in order to reach its final destination faster. An express train need not be a particularly fast train, although it is expected to run faster than the ordinary passengers on the same route.

SUPERFAST TRAIN

A train that averages a speed of above 55 km/h from its origin to its destination.

FIREBOX

Section at the rear of a steam locomotive boiler that houses the fire that heats the water in the boiler. Fuel is fed into the firebox from the cab, and the generated heat is fed through the boiler by the fire tubes.

FIVE-YEAR PLAN

An economic programme with objectives spread over five years adopted by the Government of India. The Government prepares a document that has a plan for all its income and expenditure for the next five years. The 12th Five Year Plan (2012–17) was the last in India.